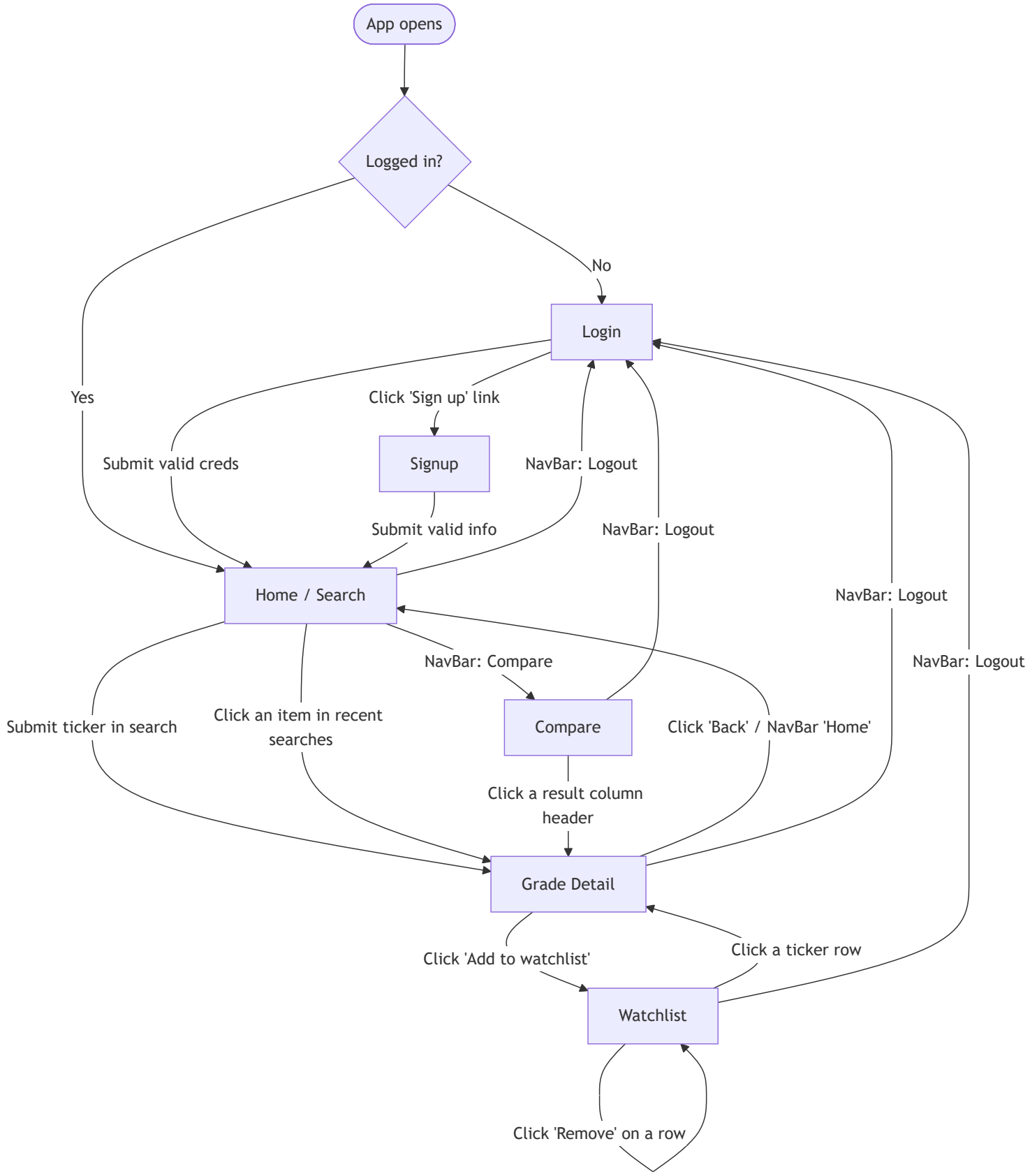
StockGrader — User Flow and Wireframes

> Visual version: `wireframes.pdf`

Planning artifact for the frontend. Maps every path a user can take through the app, and shows a low-fidelity sketch of every screen.

> The wireframes are deliberately rough — boxes, labels, and notes about behaviour. Visual polish comes from Bootstrap during the build phase, not from these sketches.

User Flow



Navigation rules:

- NavBar is visible on every screen.

- When **logged out**, NavBar shows: `StockGrader` (brand) · `Log in` · `Sign up` .
- When **logged in**, NavBar shows: `StockGrader` · `Home` · `Watchlist` · `Compare` · `Welcome, <name>` · `Logout` .

Global page footer (added Class 6 polish):

- Below the main content on every page, a small muted `StockGrader © <year>` line.
- Year is computed at render time from `new Date().getFullYear()` so it auto-updates each January.

Wireframes

Six screens. For each one: the main element, the actions a user can take, and the four states the instructor requires (happy / loading / empty / error).

1. Login `/login`

```
+---------------------------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader                         [Dark]  Log in    Sign up |  <- NavBar
+---------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                               |
|   Log in                            |   What is StockGrader?  |
|                                     |                         |
|   [ Error alert (red, auto-         |   A quick fundamental   |
|     dismisses after 5s) ]           |   health check for any  |
|                                     |   publicly traded stock.|
|   [ Sign in with Google ]           |                         |
|   ─────── or ───────                |   Grades A through F    |
|                                     |   based on:             |
|   Email                             |    • Topline rev growth |
|   [ ________________________ ]      |    • Recent rev (TTM)   |
|                                     |    • Positive FCF       |
|   Password                          |    • FCF growth (LT)    |
|   [ ________________________ ]      |    • Recent FCF (TTM)   |
|                                     |                         |
|   [   Log in   ]                    |   Score: 5 = A · 0–1 = F|
|                                     |                         |
|   Don't have an account? Sign up    |   Data from Yahoo,      |
|                                     |   refreshed every 24h.  |
|                                                               |
|       ░░░█▌█░█░░██░░█░░░█░░█░  <- candlestick band           |
|                                                               |
|                  StockGrader © 2026                           |
+---------------------------------------------------------------+
```

- **Main:** Email + password form on the left, "What is StockGrader?" explainer card on the right.
- **Actions:** submit form, click Google button, click "Sign up" link.
- **Layout:** form + card side-by-side at ≥768px; stack vertically on phones (form first).
- **States:**
  - *happy* → navigate to Home.
  - *loading* → submit button shows "Logging in…" and disabled.
  - *error* → red alert with backend message, **auto-dismisses after 5 seconds**.
  - *empty* → N/A.

2. Signup `/signup`

```
+----------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader                Log in  Sign up  |
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader                        [Dark]  Log in    Sign up  |
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                                |
|   Sign up                           |   What is StockGrader?   |
|                                     |                          |
|   [ Error alert (red, auto-         |   A quick fundamental    |
|     dismisses after 5s) ]           |   health check for any   |
|                                     |   publicly traded stock. |
|   [ Sign in with Google ]           |                          |
|   ─────── or ───────                |   Grades A through F     |
|                                     |   based on:              |
|   Display name (optional)           |    • Topline rev growth  |
|   [ ________________________ ]      |    • Recent rev (TTM)    |
|                                     |    • Positive FCF        |
|   Email                             |    • FCF growth (LT)     |
|   [ ________________________ ]      |    • Recent FCF (TTM)    |
|                                     |                          |
|   Password (≥ 6 characters)         |   Score: 5 = A · 0–1 = F |
|   [ ________________________ ]      |                          |
|                                     |   Data from Yahoo,       |
|   [  Create account  ]              |   refreshed every 24h.   |
|                                                                |
|   Already registered? Log in                                   |
|                                                                |
|       ░░░▓█░▓░░▓░░▓██░░░▓░░░░▓░░▓░  <- candlestick band        |
|                                                                |
|                   StockGrader © 2026                           |
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
```

- **Main:** Registration form on the left, "What is StockGrader?" explainer card on the right.
- **Actions:** submit form, click Google button, click "Log in" link.
- **Layout:** form + card side-by-side at ≥768px; stack vertically on phones.
- **States:**
  - *happy* → log user in automatically + navigate to Home.
  - *loading* → disabled button.
  - *error* → red alert (e.g. "email already in use"), **auto-dismisses after 5 seconds**.

   - *empty* → N/A.

3. Home `/`

Home has two layouts depending on whether the user is signed in. Logged-in users get recent searches; logged-out users get the "What is StockGrader?" pitch card beside the search box.

Logged-in (recent searches):

```
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader  Home  Watchlist  Compare  [Dark]        Logout  |
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                                |
|   Grade a stock                                                |
|                                                                |
|   Enter a ticker symbol or company name to get a letter       |
|   grade and a five-point breakdown.                            |
|                                                                |
|   [ e.g. AAPL or Apple        ] [  Get grade  ]                |
|                                                                |
|   ----------------------------------------------------         |
|                                                                |
|   Recent searches                                              |
|                                                                |
|   - MSFT  Microsoft Corporation            2026-06-04         |
|   - AAPL  Apple Inc.                       2026-06-04         |
|   - GOOG  Alphabet Inc.                    2026-06-01         |
|                                                                |
|       ░░░▓░▓░░▓░░▓▓░░▓░░░▓░░▓░  <- candlestick band           |
|                                                                |
|                 StockGrader © 2026                             |
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
```

Logged-out (with About card beside search):

```
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader                       [Dark]  Log in    Sign up  |
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                                |
|   Grade a stock                    |   What is StockGrader?   |
|                                    |                          |
|   Enter a ticker symbol or         |   A quick fundamental    |
|   company name to get a letter     |   health check for any   |
|   grade and a five-point           |   publicly traded stock. |
|   breakdown.                       |                          |
|                                    |   Grades A through F     |
|   [ e.g. AAPL or Apple ]           |   based on:              |
|   [  Get grade  ]                  |    • Topline rev growth  |
|                                    |    • Recent rev (TTM)    |
|                                    |    • Positive FCF        |
|                                    |    • FCF growth (LT)     |
|                                    |    • Recent FCF (TTM)    |
|                                    |                          |
|                                    |   Score: 5 = A · 0–1 = F |
|                                    |                          |
|                                    |   Data from Yahoo,       |
|                                    |   refreshed every 24h.   |
|                                                                |
|       ░░░▓▓░▓░▓▓░▓░░▓░▓░  <- candlestick band                 |
|                                                                |
|                  StockGrader © 2026                            |
+----------------------------------------------------------------+
```

- **Main:** Ticker-or-name search box. Recent searches list when logged in; About card when logged out.
- **Actions:** submit a ticker or company name → navigate to `/grade/:query` . Click a recent search row → navigate to `/grade/:ticker` . Toggle the NavBar dark-mode switch.
- **Layout:** search + About card side-by-side at ≥768px when logged out; stack vertically on phones.
- **States:** *happy* → recent searches list (logged in) or About card (logged out) renders. *loading* → "Loading…" placeholder for recent searches. *empty* → "No searches yet — grade your first ticker above." *error* → "Couldn't load recent searches" inline message.

4. Grade Detail `/grade/:query`

The URL accepts either a ticker (`/grade/AAPL`) or a company name (`/grade/Apple`); the backend resolves names to the canonical ticker before fetching.

```
+-------------------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader  Home  Watchlist  Compare  [Dark]  Logout  |
+-------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                       |
|   AAPL   $310.61 USD             [Add to watchlist]   |
|   Apple Inc.                                          |
|                                                       |
|   +------------------+                                |
|   |                  |                                |
|   |        B         |  <- letter grade, big          |
|   |                  |                                |
|   +------------------+                                |
|                                                       |
|   Criteria                                            |
|   [x] Topline revenue growth (long-term)              |
|       latest: $416B   vs earliest: $394B              |
|   [x] Recent revenue growth (TTM)                     |
|       TTM: $451B      vs latest: $416B                |
|   [x] Net positive free cash flow                     |
|       latest FCF: $101B                               |
|   [ ] Free cash flow growth (long-term)               |
|       latest: $99B    vs earliest: $111B              |
|   [x] Recent free cash flow growth (TTM)              |
|       TTM: $112B      vs latest: $101B                |
|                                                       |
|   Graded at: 2026-06-03 08:13 (from cache)            |
|                                                       |
+-------------------------------------------------------+
```

- **Main:** Canonical ticker + share price + company name header, letter grade card, 5-criteria checklist with the actual numbers.
- **Actions:** "Add to watchlist" → POST `/api/watchlist` then show inline success/failure alert.
- **States:**
  - *happy* → grade + criteria render.
  - *loading* → spinner with "Grading `<ticker>` …".
  - *empty* → N/A (a query is always specified by URL).
  - *error (logged out)* → friendly info alert: "Please log in to grade stocks" with Log in / Sign up buttons (no scary heading).
  - *error (logged in)* → "Couldn't grade …" red alert.

5. Watchlist `/watchlist`

```
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader  Home  Watchlist  Compare  [Dark]  Welcome, Cory          Logout |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                                               |
|   Your watchlist                                                              |
|   The "Current" grade reflects the latest cached grade. To refresh a          |
|   ticker, open its page from the Ticker column.                               |
|                                                                               |
|   Add:  [ e.g. MSFT or Microsoft ] [ Add ]                                    |
|                                                                               |
|   Ticker | Name              | Last price   | Added     | At add | Now | Change       | |
|   ------ | ----------------- | ------------ | --------- | ------ | --- | ------------ | |
|   MSFT   | Microsoft Corp.   | $426.28 USD  | 6/3/2026  |   B    |  A  | ▲ Upgraded   | [Remove
|   AAPL   | Apple Inc.        | $310.61 USD  | 6/3/2026  |   B    |  B  | — No change  | [Remove
|   TSLA   | Tesla, Inc.       | $228.50 USD  | 6/1/2026  |   B    |  D  | ▼ Downgraded | [Remove
|   GOOG   | Alphabet Inc.     | —            | 5/28/2026 |   —    |  C  | — (legacy)   | [Remove
|                                                                               |
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------------+
```

- **Main:** Table of saved tickers with company name, last cached price + currency, added date, the grade captured at add time, current cached grade, and an upgrade / downgrade / no-change indicator.
- **Actions:**
  - **Add by ticker or name** (POST `/api/watchlist`) — backend resolves names to canonical tickers and freezes the current grade as `gradeAtAdd`.
  - **Remove** a row (DELETE `/api/watchlist/:ticker`).
  - Click the ticker link → navigate to its Grade Detail (this also refreshes the cache, which propagates back to the Watchlist on next load).
- **Responsive behavior:** at phone width (`< 576px`) the four lower-priority columns (Name, Last price, Added, Grade at add) are hidden — only Ticker, Current, Change, and Remove remain visible so the table fits a 360px viewport without horizontal scroll. All 8 columns return at ≥576px.
- **States:** *happy* → table renders. *loading* → "Loading your watchlist…" *empty* → "Your watchlist is empty. Add a ticker above." *error* → red Bootstrap Alert with the failure reason.

6. Compare `/compare`

Two view modes once results have loaded — toggle with the **Cards / Table** buttons.

Cards view (default — full breakdown per stock):

```
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
| StockGrader  Home  Watchlist  Compare  [Dark]        Logout  |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                                             |
|   Compare                                                   |
|   Grade 2 or 3 stocks and see them side by side.            |
|                                                             |
|   Stock 1 [ AAPL ]  Stock 2 [ MSFT ]  Stock 3 [ GOOG ]      |
|                                       [  Compare  ]         |
|                                                             |
|                                 [ Cards ] [ Table ]         |
|                                                             |
|   +-----------------+  +-------------------+  +------------+ |
|   |  AAPL           |  |  MSFT             |  |  GOOG      | |
|   |  Apple Inc.     |  |  Microsoft Corp.  |  |  Alphabet  | |
|   |  $310.61 USD    |  |  $426.28 USD      |  |  $355.50…  | |
|   |       B         |  |        B          |  |     B      | |
|   |---------------- |  |------------------ |  |----------- | |
|   | [x] R1          |  | [x] R1            |  | [x] R1     | |
|   | [x] R2          |  | [x] R2            |  | [x] R2     | |
|   | [x] R3          |  | [x] R3            |  | [x] R3     | |
|   | [ ] R4          |  | [x] R4            |  | [x] R4     | |
|   | [x] R5          |  | [ ] R5            |  | [ ] R5     | |
|   +-----------------+  +-------------------+  +------------+ |
|                                                             |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
```

Table view (criteria as rows, stocks as columns — easier to spot where they differ):

```
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
|                                 [ Cards ] [ Table ]         |
|                                                             |
| Criterion                       | AAPL    | MSFT    | GOOG    |
|                                 | Apple…  | Micros… | Alpha…  |
|                                 | $310.61 | $426.28 | $355.50 |
|                                 |   B     |   B     |   B     |
| ------------------------------- | ------- | ------- | ------- |
| Topline revenue growth (LT)     |  Yes    |  Yes    |  Yes    |
| Recent revenue growth (TTM)     |  Yes    |  Yes    |  Yes    |
| Net positive free cash flow     |  Yes    |  Yes    |  Yes    |
| Free cash flow growth (LT)      |  No     |  Yes    |  Yes    |
| Recent free cash flow growth    |  Yes    |  No     |  No     |
+-------------------------------------------------------------+
```

- **Main:** 2–3 tickers (or company names) compared side-by-side. Toggle between **Cards** (one card per stock with full criteria list) and **Table** (criteria as rows, stocks as columns).
- **Actions:**
  - Type tickers/names + submit → fetch via `GET /api/compare?tickers=…` and render.
  - Click **Cards** / **Table** to switch view.
  - Click any stock's column header (Table) or card header (Cards) → navigate to that ticker's Grade Detail.
- **States:** *happy* → toggle + chosen view render. *loading* → spinner with "Comparing stocks…". *empty* → form sits with defaults until submitted. *error* → if one ticker fails, that single card/column shows the error message; the others still render normally.

Consistency rules across all screens

- **NavBar** is identical on every screen and reflects login state.
- **Primary action button** uses the Bootstrap `primary` variant; destructive actions (`Remove` , `Logout`) use a muted style.
- **Error alerts** are a red Bootstrap `Alert` directly above the form or below the page heading.
- **Success alerts** are a green Bootstrap `Alert` directly above the affected element (e.g. "AAPL added to your watchlist.").
- **Banner auto-dismiss:** every Alert (success or error) automatically clears itself after 5 seconds via the shared `useAutoDismiss` hook, so banners never linger on screen.

- **Loading states** prefer disabling buttons + showing inline spinners over full-page blockers — feels snappier.
- **Empty states** explain *why* the list is empty and what to do next (never just a blank screen).
- **Mobile-first:** every screen should be usable at ~360px wide. Compare cards stack vertically and the Watchlist hides its lower-priority columns below 576px.
- **Decorative candlestick band** appears below the form on Home (logged out), Login, and Signup — sparse-content pages where it fills the dead space. Data-dense pages (Watchlist, Compare, Grade Detail) skip it.
- **Page footer** (`StockGrader © <year>` , muted text, year dynamic) sits at the bottom of every page.